

X11 CLEANING PRODUCTS AND PROTOCOLS | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Provide cleaning effectiveness by selecting less hazardous products and establishing adequate cleaning protocols and practices.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the restriction of hazardous or harmful ingredients in cleaning, disinfection and sanitization products, as well as the establishment of a cleaning plan, the maintenance of a cleaning schedule and a program training for staff.

Issue : Cleaning is fundamental for keeping a healthy indoor environment. Microorganisms such as house dust mites –ubiquitously present around the world– are directly related with asthma² and allergy² development. Surfaces may host pathogens present in feces and body fluids released by sick individuals, or through contact with another contaminated surface.³ Beyond naturally-accumulating dust, commercial cleaning products may contain ingredients that may also degrade the indoor air quality and are suspected to be hazardous to human health.⁴ Some products may emit substances that irritate the nose, eyes, throat and lungs and can cause or trigger asthma attacks.⁵ Moreover, the interactions between cleaning agents, microbes and public health are diverse and complex^{6,7}, and we are just beginning to better understand them.⁶ Cleaning practices may cause additional health concerns. For instance, indiscriminate use of cleaning sprays is suspected to be a risk factor for adult asthma.⁸ Similarly, lack of education on the use of gloves during wet cleaning activities may explain the high prevalence of hand dermatitis in the cleaning service industry.^{9,10}

Solutions : A thorough plan for cleaning operations that considers the health of occupants and cleaning staff increases the overall efficiency of the process, while reducing environmental damage.¹¹ The plan must align with advice from public health agencies for disinfection requirements.¹² Along personal protective equipment (PPE), the implementation of engineering controls (e.g., ventilation) and policies is key to reduce exposure to hazards during cleaning practices.¹³ The provision of cleaning products that contain less hazardous ingredients may reduce the risk of respiratory and dermal symptoms.⁸

PART 1 IMPROVE CLEANING PRACTICES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

Option 1: Cleaning plan development and implementation

The project develops and implements a cleaning plan that meets the following requirements:

- a.
 - Details the following:¹¹
 1. Extent and frequency of cleaning.
 2. Cleaning responsibilities of building occupants (if any) and cleaning staff.
 3. Cleaning supplies and where they can be accessed.
 4. Process to evaluate and document adherence to the cleaning plan.
- b. Identifies the following:
 1. Surfaces that require disinfection (e.g., high-touch surfaces).
 2. Frequency and/or other thresholds (e.g., number of hours, number users of a space, results from a swab test) for disinfection.
 3. Applicable governmental registration and directions of use (e.g., contact time and dilution rates) for disinfectants.
 4. Other non-chemical tools used for disinfection, if any.
- c. States the following documentation procedures:¹¹
 1. Record keeping practices for cleaning and disinfection activities.
 2. The chain of communications with building occupants.
 3. A system to log feedback from occupants and cleaning staff.
- d. Specifies the following for cleaning materials and personal protection equipment (PPE):
 1. PPE requirements for general cleaning and specialized tasks (e.g., disinfection or dilution or chemicals).
 2. Color-coding for reusable and disposable cleaning cloths.
 3. Separate cleaning of reusable cleaning materials from other clothing or products.
- e. Includes the following precautions for storage of cleaning products:
 1. An identifiable, fit-for-purpose storage space in accordance with the manufacturers' directions; bleach stored away from other products.
 2. Color-coding and labeling of any bleach-based and ammonia-based products, indicating they are not to be mixed with one another.
- f. Specifies the following for cleaning tools and equipment:
 1. HEPA rated filters for vacuum cleaners.¹
 2. If carpet and woven upholstery are present, the cleaning methodology (based on manufacturer's recommendations), favoring hot water extraction if technically feasible.
 3. Protocols for cleaning, maintenance and handling of waste accumulated in equipment (e.g., used vacuum cleaner bags).

- g. Includes the following operational aspects:
 1. Use of cleaning and disinfection products, including dilutions (when needed) and ventilation requirements.
 2. On-site availability of current Safety Data Sheets (SDS) of cleaning and disinfection products, in languages spoken by the cleaning staff.
 3. Precautions to avoid slip hazards during and after floor cleaning.
 4. Safe disposal of waste, including soiled cleaning materials and PPE.
- h. Outlines a training program that meets the following:
 1. Training covers cross-contamination prevention via hand hygiene, PPE, cleaning cloth replacement, cloth handling techniques and carrying systems to separate clean tools from dirty ones.
 2. Training is delivered to all relevant personnel including building management, building operators and contracted cleaning staff, on an annual basis, and whenever protocols change.

OR

Option 2: Certified cleaning provider

The project or organization retains a cleaning provider certified under one of the following standards:

- a. Green Seal® Standard for Commercial and Institutional Cleaning Services, GS-42, operated by Green Seal Inc.¹⁸
- b. Cleaning Industry Management Standard (CIMS) - GB criteria, operated by ISSA.¹⁹
- c. Nordic Swan Ecolabelling for Cleaning Services criteria, operated by Nordic Ecolabelling.²⁰
- d. British Institute of Cleaning Science (BISc) accredited training.

PART 2 SELECT PREFERRED CLEANING PRODUCTS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

The project or organization has a cleaning policy that lists all surface cleaning and disinfection products and specifies that they meet the following requirements:

- a. Cleaning products as-sold meet one of the following:
 1. Are labeled as 'low-hazard' or 'safer' by an ISO [Reference](#),¹⁴ or by a third-party certification recognized by the local government where the building is located.
 2. Have ingredients disclosed through a Safety Data Sheet (SDS) that meets EU Regulation 2015/830 (CLP),¹⁵ or through a disclosure document that meets California State Bill No. 258, and there are no ingredients listed in the disclosure document present at 100 ppm (0.01%) or above that are classified with the following codes and hazard statements as defined by the Globally Harmonized System (GHS): H311, H312, H317, H334, H340, H350, H360, H372.
 3. Meet Feature X08 Materials Optimization.
- b. Products labeled as disinfectants meet the following:
 1. Have all antimicrobial efficacy claims registered by a governmental office and stated in their label.
 2. Utilize only active ingredients only from the following list: citric acid, hydrogen peroxide, L-lactic acid, ethanol, isopropanol, peroxyacetic acid, sodium bisulfate, chitosan.
 3. Section 2 of the SDS does not contain the following GHS codes: H311, H312, H317, H334, H340, H350, H360, H372.

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